

Trade Me Data Seekers Workshop

Overview

This workshop is designed to introduce to CoCo - Snowflakes AI coding assistant. during the workshop you will:

1. Navigate Snowflake and understand where Trade Me's data lives
2. Use CoCo to write and iterate on SQL queries without needing to be a SQL expert
3. Create a re-usable CoCo skill to help create a repeatable analysis
4. Build a simple Streamlit app to turn a recurring question into a team-accessible tool

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Module 2 — From Question to Answer: AI-Assisted SQL with CoCo	Use plain English prompts to generate SQL queries, iterate and refine them, and tackle advanced multi-join analysis with CoCo.
Module 3 — Advanced Analysis and Creating Re-usable Skills	Build a multi-step analysis, generate a standalone HTML report, and package it all as a reusable CoCo skill.
Module 4 — Team-Ready Tools: Building a Streamlit App with CoCo	Scaffold and deploy a multi-page Streamlit app that turns recurring questions into a self-service tool for the team.

Workshop Flow

Module 1 — Workspaces : Your Personal Data Lab

Learning Objective: Set up and use a personal workspace, understand the workspace types available (personal, shared, git-backed), organise files for future reuse, and using the result pane for simple analysis.

Flow:

Exercise 1a — Create Your Workspace and run a SQL query:

1. Select **Projects** then **Workspaces** from the left hand menu.
2. Click the + icon at the top of the workspaces panel and select **Private Workspace**. Name your workspace: <your_name>_data_lab.
3. Create a new SQL file inside your Workspace by clicking the + **Add New** button and selecting **SQL file**
4. Name the file : **Module1.sql**. You will now have an empty worksheet ready to write some SQL.
5. Before we get started we need to set which database and schema we want to work with. to do this:
 - 5.1 In the top right hand corner of the worksheet click the database icon
 - 5.2 Select **ANALYTICS** from **Databases** list
 - 5.3 Select **SANDBOX** from the **Schemas** list

See the screen shot below for an example:



6. Copy and paste this query into the worksheet and run the query by clicking the blue **Run** button in the top left hand of the worksheet.

```
select * from workshop__jobs_listings limit 500;
```

NOTE: if the query does not return any results, or you get an error, you may not have set the database and schema correctly.

Exercise 1b - Explore the results tab:

The results tab is where you can view, and work with, the results of a query.

Table view - Shows tabular results. It shows a profile of the data in each column. This can be toggled on and off by clicking the **Show Column Stats** icon (The little graph in the top left cell of the results). You can also search within the results set, show / hide columns, access the query plan, and download the results as a CSV.

1. Click the **Search** icon in the results pane and search for "Legal". Note how it filters the results. Clear the search box by clicking the X icon in the search box.
2. Click the **Column Selection** icon. Untick the MEMBER_ID column and click the **Apply** button at the bottom of the list. Note how the column is removed from the results set.
3. Click the **Download** icon. This allows you to download the results set as a CSV file.

Chart view - This allows you to create basic charts directly from the results set. Its great for quickly visualising the results.

1. Click the **Chart** button then select **Bar Chart** from the Chart Type drop down.
2. Select **INDUSTRY** as the x-axis column
3. Select **LISTING_ID** as the Y-axis column.
4. Change the Aggregate to **COUNT**.
5. Change the Group by to **ROLE_TYPE**

Pivot view - This allows you to create a pivot table directly from the results set.

1. Click the **Add row Fields** box and select the **INDUSTRY** column
2. Click the **Add column Fields** box and select the **ROLE_TYPE** column
3. Click the **Add value Fields** box and select **LISTING_ID**.
4. Change the **Aggregation** to **COUNT**

Wrap-up A private workspace is a space for you to write queries and code, build apps, and more. You can manage your files using folders; you can upload files and folders; and you can manage file versions.

Module 1 Snowflake Skills / Features:

Snowflake Workspaces (personal workspace — hands-on; shared and git-backed — concept awareness)
Workspace file management
Working with the Results pane for simple analysis, charting, and pivot tables

Module 2 — From Question to Answer: AI-Assisted SQL with CoCo

Learning Objective: Use Cortex Code (CoCo) to write, refine, and understand SQL queries — starting from plain English and building up to multi-step analysis — without needing to be a SQL expert.

Flow:

Exercise 2a — Simple Query from Plain English

1. Click the CoCo tab on the right hand side of the screen to display the CoCo panel. (The blue tab with the Star in it)
2. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo and hit enter on your keyboard, or click the blue ***Send** icon in the chat field.

What **tables** are in the ANALYTICS.SANDBOX **schema** that **start with** WORKSHOP?

CoCo will run a metadata query to get a list of the tables. Note how CoCo provides some additional data such as Row Count and Description.

3. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo and hit enter on your keyboard, or click the blue ***Send** icon in the chat field.

How many **job** listings are there?

Notice that CoCo just answered the question in the chat window? If you are curious you can see the SQL it generated and ran by clicking the "Expand" icon. (See screenshot below)



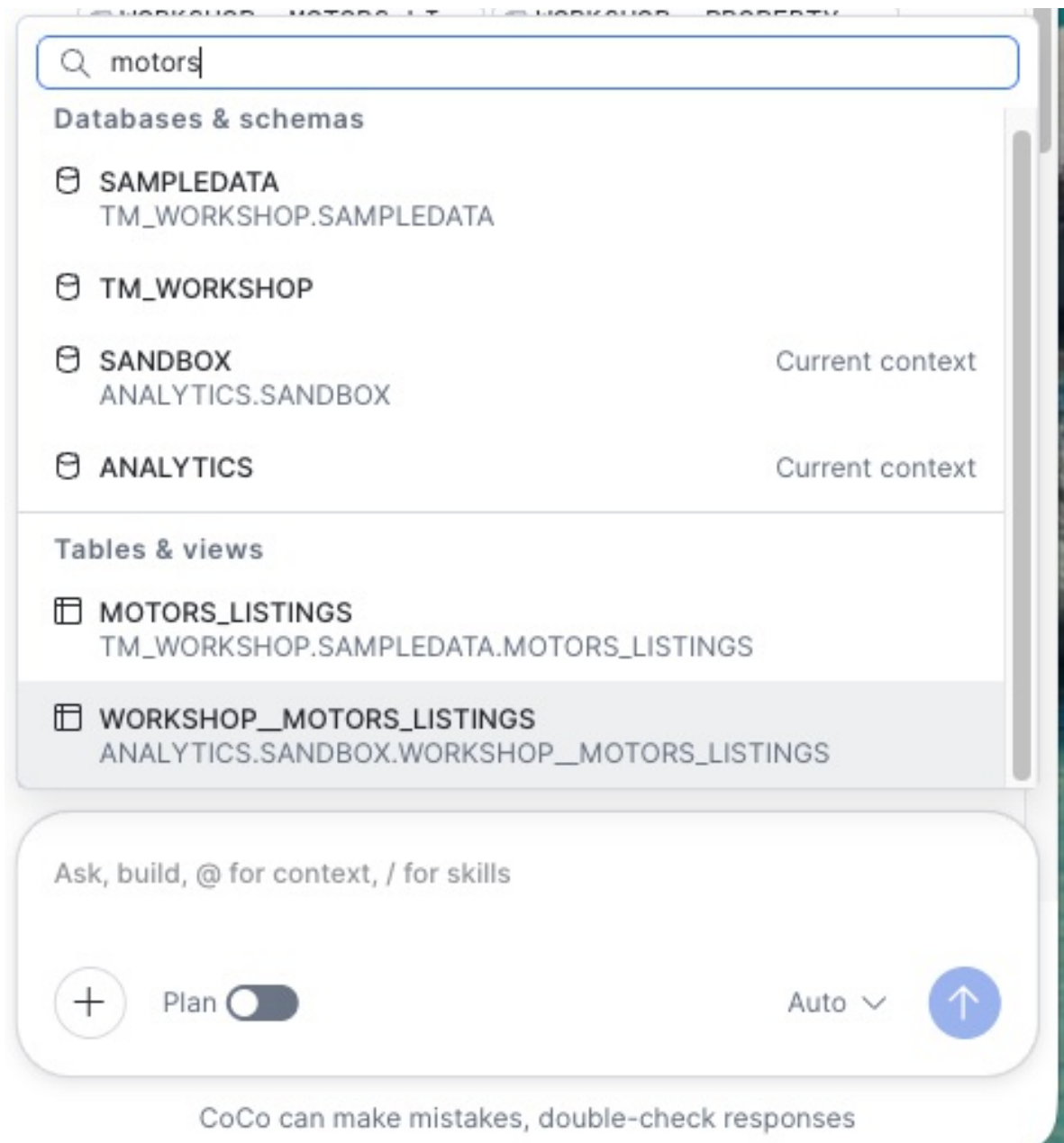
You could copy the SQL query and paste it into the worksheet if you wanted to re-use it, or you could be more specific in your prompt.

4. Copy and paste the following into CoCo.

Create a new query that **returns** how many listings there **are**?

Note this time CoCo adds the query text to the SQL worksheet. Also note how it highlights the changes and provides the option to "Keep" the changes or "Undo" the changes. Click "Keep All". This makes it easy to see what code CoCo has created, deleted or changed in your file.

5. We actually have multiple "listings" tables in the database - Jobs, Motors, Marketplace, Property. What happens if you quickly want to check Motors listings? You could explicitly mention motors listings in your prompt but you can also provide CoCo with Context to guide it to the right database, schema, table, or view for example.
6. Click the **+** icon in the CoCo **chat** box, then type WORKSHOP__MOTORS in the search box. (NOTE there are 2 underscores in the name). The **WORKSHOP__MOTORS_LISTINGS** table should be displayed in the list. Click **WORKSHOP__MOTORS_LISTINGS** result to add this table as context for CoCo.



7. Now copy and paste the following prompt.

How many listings **are** there?

Note how CoCo queries the **WORKSHOP__MOTORS_LISTINGS** table. This is because we provided the table as context. Providing context like this is useful when you have access to a lot of databases, schema, and tables. It means CoCo does not need to waste time (and tokens) performing metadata queries to try and figure out what tables it needs to query.

TIP: Providing context and being specific with your prompts can really help CoCo

Exercise 2b — Iterate and Refine:

Now ask CoCo these questions in turn. If CoCo changes the SQL in the Worksheet just click "Keep Changes". Make sure each query actually runs by clicking anywhere in the query, then clicking the blue **Run Query** button.

1. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo:

Create a query **to show open** job listings **by** category

Note how it creates a new query and includes a WHERE clause that filters the data on status, and a GROUP BY clause to get the count per category. Remember to click the **Keep All** button to retain the changes.

2. Click anywhere in the query then click the blue **Run** button to run the query. Does it return any results?
3. If it does not return any results it may be that CoCo looked for listings with a status of "Open" (because that's what we asked for)
4. Highlight the query with your mouse, and click the **Add to Chat** button, then type the following prompt into CoCo:

this returns **no** results



CoCo will use the query as context for your question and it will attempt to diagnose and fix the query. It should determine that "Open" is not a valid status and modify the query to use "Active" instead. Click ****Keep Changes**** and then re-run the query.

2. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo:

Create a query **to return** total job listings **per month** per category **for the last 18** months

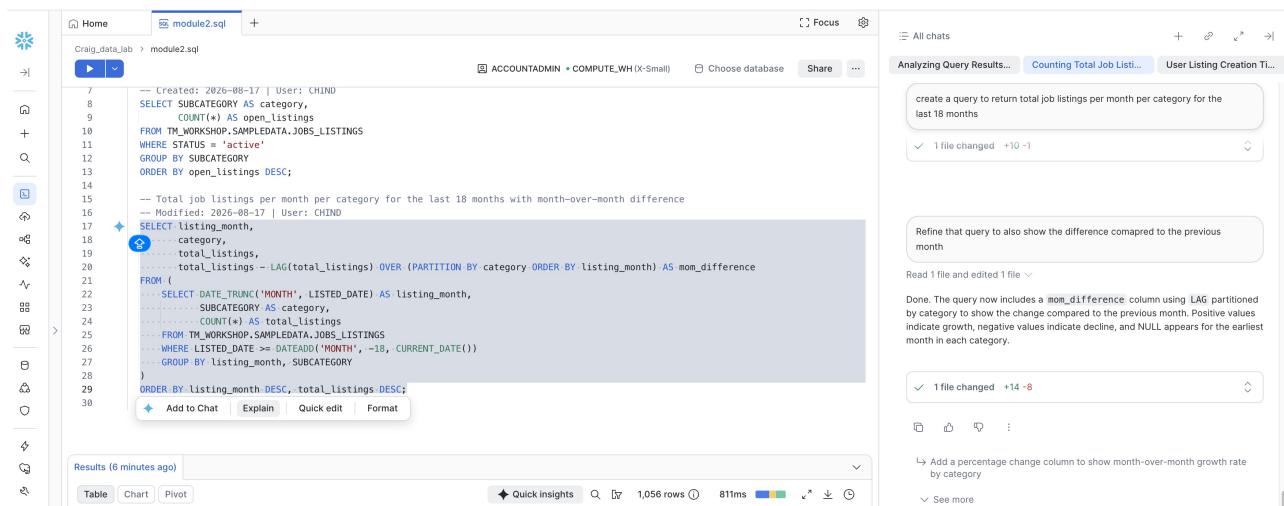
Note how the SQL gets a bit more complicated. You may see DATE functions being used along with filters in the WHERE clause and grouping via the GROUP BY clause.

3. Click anywhere in the query then click the blue **Run** button to run the query.
4. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo:

Refine that query **to** also show **the difference** compared **to the** previous month

Note that it modified the last query it created even though you only said "refine that query...". You will notice the SQL query might now include a sub-query and some different functions. Don't forget to click **Keep Changes**

5. Now with your mouse **highlight** the query and then select **Explain** from the menu that pops up. CoCo will then explain what the query is doing. This is great for understanding SQL that CoCo generates or if you are using SQL written by someone else.



Exercise 2c — Advanced Query: Multi-Join, CTEs, Aggregation, and JSON

Lets ask CoCo to build a more complex query that may mirror the kind of question an analyst would normally tackle.

1. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo:

Create a **new** query that returns:

The **number of "Contacts"** by reason, **for each of the last 3 months** , that required escalation **and** how that compares **to the** same months **last year**, **and** against **the monthly average from the previous 12 months**

Review both the response that CoCo provides in the chat after creating the query and the query itself. Notice how CoCo provides a explanation of the query it just created especially the logic / business rules it applied.

Wrap-up CoCo is great for creating and modifying SQL queries against your Snowflake data. It knows Snowflake, it knows SQL, and it has hte context about you data it needs to create the queries.

Module 2 Snowflake Skills / Features:

Workspaces "diff" feature to see what additions, deletions, and changes CoCo makes to your queries
Leveraging CoCo to write simple and advanced SQL queries.

Understanding that you can provide CoCo with "context" which could be a table, or an entire schema or database.

Leveraging CoCo to help you understand what a SQL query is in plain language.

Module 3 - Advanced Analysis and creating re-usable skills:

Exercise 3a — Building a multi-step Analysis

Often you may have the need to produce some insight that may need multiple queries to produce the data you need. You could build these up 1 at a time but we can also get CoCo to accelerate this kind of analysis. You can even use CoCo to help identify and refine the requirements.

1. Add a new **SQL file** to your workspace and rename it: **marketplace_performance.sql**

2. In the top right hand corner of the worksheet click the database icon, Select **ANALYTICS** from **Databases** list then select **SANDBOX** from the **Schemas** list
3. Create a new CoCo session by clicking the **+** icon at the **Top** of the CoCo pane. This will give a new chat window with no history

TIP: Managing session context is really important. The context window has limited space so when you start a new task or job, it pays to create a new session. You can have multiple sessions going at once if you need to perform multiple tasks. To see all chats click **All Chats** at the top of the CoCo window.

4. In the CoCo panel toggle the **Plan** switch to the **on** position. Planning allows CoCo to think about how it will solve a problem and present a plan that you can review before it writes any code. This is a really useful step especially for more complex tasks.
5. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo.

I need to design the Head of Marketplace (who owns Marketing place listings) with an analysis of Monthly Marketplace listing performance that they can review each month at their leadership team meeting.

Some of the insights they want includes:

Number of new listings created in last 7 days, 14 day, 30 days, year to date.

Number of new listings created in last 7 days, 14 day, 30 days, year to date compared with the same periods the previous year

Top 5 and bottom 5 Listing categories by increase or decrease last month vs the month before

Sold vs unsold listing count and percentage by Region

Contacts by members that relate to marketplace listings

Also Review the tables in the SANDBOX schema and make suggestions on other insights that might be relevant to the Head of marketplace listings. Ask me any relevant clarification questions .

TIP: Prompting CoCO to ask clarification questions is a great way too help ensure CoCO gets all the information it might need.

Note CoCo may ask you some questions. These may include:

- Clarifying if you only want to include listings from the marketplace_listings table - Answer "Marketplace Listings" only.
- Clarifying what "Category" column you want to use as there are category and sub category fields - Choose the CATEGORY field
- If you want one query or multiple queries - Choose multiple / separate queries
- Clarifying the rules for "Sold vs Unsold" - You want any status that is not sold = Unsold.

Once CoCo has finished review the plan it came up with. Note that it has outlined the proposed queries it will create. Also note the additional suggested insights. You can leverage CoCo to help identify other analysis ideas. If you wanted to, you could iterate on the plan with CoCo to get it to the ideal state.

5. Toggle the **Plan** switch to the **off** position.
6. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo

Proceed **with the** build. Include all **the** suggested additional insights. Add **a** comment **to each** query explaining what **it** does.

Once CoCo has finished review the SQL it generated. Do not forget to click **Keep changes** . Note it has created a query for each item in the plan. Some are simple and some are more complex.

7. Run 2 or 3 of the queries that CoCo created to make sure they run as expected.

Exercise 3b — Build a HTML report:

Now we have the queries to produce the data we need to answer the leadership teams questions, but we need a nicer way to present that data.

1. Toggle the **Plan** switch to the **On** position.
2. Copy and paste the following prompt into coco

I want **to create a** HTML report that shows **the** results **of** SQL queries that can be used **in the** leadership team meeting.

My requirements **include:**

The HTML report should be static **and** standalone

The layout should be **in a** presentation style **with one "page" for each** analysis **and** navigation **to** move forward **and** back

There should be **a** Title **"page"**

Each section should have **a** title, **and a** brief description **of** what is being shown., **and the** data/insight

Where appropriate use **a** chart **to** visualise **the** data, **or a** metric/KPI card **for** single data points.

Use **a** table **if** appropriate.

Ask me **any** relevant clarification questions. Make suggestions **on how I could possibly improve the output**

CoCo may ask you some clarification questions. These may include:

- Colour Theme - Choose either Light or Dark if you get asked.
 - Charts library - Choose the **Chart.js** option if you get asked.
 - Branding - Choose "Generic branding" if you get asked.
3. Review the plan that CoCo proposes. Take note of the suggested improvements to see if they make sense. Normally you may iterate on the plan to get it "just right" but today we will proceed with the build. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo:

Proceed **with the** build. Include **the** suggested improvements. Create all **files in the** current workspace.

NOTE: The build may take a few minutes

4. Once CoCo has finished you should have a new "HTML" file in your Workspace. Currently you cannot render HTML files in Workspaces so you will need to **Download** the HTML to your laptop to view it. To do this:

- Click the HTML file in the Workspaces file pane
- Click the ellipsis (3 dots) to the right of the file name
- Select **Download** from the menu that pops up
- Once downloaded locate the file on your laptop and open it in a new browser window.
- Navigate through the report.

Exercise 3c — Build a Reusable CoCo Skill (25 min):

You've built a solid multi-step analysis, and generate a HTML report, but this is a statics asset. We need to be able to re-create this each month or when. Now you'll package it as a **CoCo Skill** — a reusable prompt file that lets anyone (including future-you) run this same analysis with a single command.

1. Toggle the **Plan** switch to the **on** position
2. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo

I want **to** make **the** report generator **a** re-usable asset. Help me **create a new** CoCo skill that will enable me **to**: Ask **the** user what month **and** year they want **to** run **the** report **for**. Default **to the** previous month. Runs **the** SQL queries **and** produce **a new** HTML file Ensure **the** file name includes **the** Month **and** year, **and a** timestamp **for** report run.

Once CoCo has finished review the plan.

3. Toggle the **Plan** switch to the **off** position then copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo:

Proceed **with the** build

Once CoCo has finished creating your new skill test it out. Don't forget to click the **Keep All** changes button.

4. In the CoCo chat box type **/marketplace** . You should see your new skill appear in the search results under **Personal Skills**



5. Click the skill so it gets added to the chat window then click the **Send** button on the chat window. (or hit enter on your keyboard)

CoC will then load the skill. It should prompt you to enter the Month and Year. Pick **July 2026** and click submit. CoCo will now run the report.

Once it is complete you should see a new HTML file appear in your workspaces file list.

6. Currently you cannot render HTML files in Workspaces so you will need to **Download** the HTML to your laptop to view it. To do this:
 - Click the HTML file in the Workspaces file pane
 - Click the ellipsis (3 dots) to the right of the file name
 - Select **Download** from the menu that pops up
 - Once downloaded locate the file on your laptop and open it in a new browser window.
 - Navigate through the report and check it is correct.

Wrap-up: Key message: *CoCo can write SQL that would take an experienced analyst 30 minutes to compose from scratch. Skills let you package that work so it's repeatable with a single command. Your job shifts from writing syntax to asking the right question, verifying the answer, and making it reusable.*

Snowflake Skills / Features:

Cortex Code (CoCo) — SQL generation from natural language
CoCo iterative refinement (follow-up prompts)
CoCo "explain this code" capability
Advanced SQL patterns: CTEs, multi-table JOINS, aggregation, JSON/VARIANT field extraction
Progressive query building — layering complexity iteratively
Workspaces results pane: column chooser, sorting, chart view and customisation, CSV download
CoCo Skills — creating, customising, and invoking reusable prompt-based skills\

Module 4 — Team-Ready Tools: Building a Streamlit App with CoCo (50 min)

Learning Objective: Use CoCo to scaffold a simple Streamlit app that turns a recurring business question into a self-service tool any team member can use — without needing to maintain a dashboard or wait for an analyst.

Flow:

Exercise 4a: building a data driven application

1. Create a new CoCo session by clicking the **+** icon at the **Top** of the CoCo pane.

TIP: Managing session context is really important. The context window has limited space so when you start a new task or job, it pays to create a new session. You can have multiple sessions going at once.

2. Toggle the **Plan** mode switch to **on**.
3. Copy and paste the following prompt into CoCo:

Build an interactive Streamlit app **in** a new workspace folder called "**marketplace-listings-app**" **that** uses data **from** ANALYTICS.SANDBOX.WORKSHOP__MARKETPLACE_LISTINGS, ANALYTICS.SANDBOX.WORKSHOP__AD_REVENUE, **and** ANALYTICS.SANDBOX.WORKSHOP__CONTACTS tables.

App Purpose

A multi-purpose tool **for** marketplace listing team members: daily monitoring dashboard, self-service analytics **for** ad-hoc exploration, **and** presentation-ready views **for** leadership meetings.

Structure

- Sidebar navigation **with 4** pages:

1. Executive Summary — KPI cards **with** trend sparklines, YoY comparison, goal progress bars, threshold alerts
2. Listings & Categories — Top/bottom **5** categories **by** MoM change, sell-**through by** category, new listings breakdown
3. Revenue & Engagement — Ad revenue **with** MoM trends, engagement metrics (views, watchlist, bids) **by** category, price trends
4. Operations — Sold vs unsold **by** region (stacked bar), **time-to-sell by** region, contact reasons **with** escalation rates

Global Features (sidebar, persisted across pages)

- Date window selector: Last **7** days, Last **14** days, Last **30** days, Year **to date**
- Category multi-select filter (populated dynamically **from** data)
- Region multi-select filter (populated dynamically **from** data)
- Comparison toggles **on** category **and** revenue pages: Absolute / MoM Change / MoM %
- Goal tracking: user-configurable monthly new listings target **and** sell-**through** rate target, shown **as** progress bars **on** Executive Summary

Threshold Alerts (fixed defaults)

- Sell-**through** rate: red **below 25%**, yellow **below 35%**
- Escalation rate: red **above 20%**, yellow **above 15%**
- YoY decline **in** new listings: yellow warning

CoCo may ask you some clarification questions. Answer them as best you can. Once you have answered the questions CoCo will develop the plan. Once complete review the plan.

NOTE: For the purposes of the workshop we have developed a comprehensive prompt. In the real world you could leverage CoCo to help you design the app, then ask it to create a prompt that you can use to generate the app. Or you could upload a set of requirements, or a mock up even, and ask CoCo to build off that.

4. Now you have reviewed the plan ask coco to build. Copy and paste the following prompt :

Proceed **with the** build.

CoCo will built your Stream lit application. It may take a few minutes for the build to complete. Once complete you are ready to test it.

5. You should see a new **marketplace-listings-app** folder in your Workspace. Inside the folder should be a file called **streamlit_app.py**. Click the file to open it.



6. When the file opens you should see a blue **Run** button in the top left hand corner. Click the **Run** button.



7. A new tab should open and your app should load and should look similar to the one below.



8. Navigate your way around the app and check out each page. Try using the filters in the left hand menu to make sure the app

If you have some spare time you could try the following :

- Ask CoCo to re-style the streamlit app using www.trademe.co.nz for inspiration.
- Ask CoCo to add a marketplace listing sub category filter into the app.
-

Snowflake Skills / Features:

Leveraging CoCo to build a data driven streamlit app

Running a Streamlit app locally in your workspace

CONGRATULATIONS - you have reached the end of the workshop.

To recap some of the CoCo specific things you learnt today:

- Start a new CoCo session for each distinct task. The context window has limited space, so switching topics without clearing context can lead to confused or lower-quality responses.
- Provide explicit table context rather than relying on CoCo to discover tables. This saves time and tokens, and ensures CoCo queries the correct table when multiple similar ones exist.
- Use Plan mode for complex, multi-step tasks before asking CoCo to build. Reviewing and iterating on a plan first produces better results than jumping straight into code generation.
- Be specific in your prompts about where you want output to go. Saying "create a new query" versus just asking a question determines whether CoCo writes to your worksheet or just answers in chat.
- Use the "Explain" feature on any SQL you don't fully understand. Highlight code and select Explain — this is valuable whether the SQL came from CoCo or from a colleague.
- Skills turn one-off work into repeatable assets. If you find yourself running the same analysis more than once, package it as a CoCo skill so anyone on the team can invoke it with a single command.
- Answer CoCo's clarification questions thoughtfully. The quality of the output depends heavily on how well you define scope, filters, and business rules when CoCo asks for them.
- CoCo can do a lot more than just write code. It can help you understand requirements, design solutions, troubleshoot issues, teach you about Snowflake and much more.

